



Opening the account: Jhandu Kumar won India's first medal in Glasgow: a bronze in the men's heavyweight division of para powerlifting. PTI

Basil turned the race into an Indian show. Gavit won gold in 10.71 seconds, setting a Games record, while Basil bagged silver clocking 10.83 seconds. The one-two finish was not merely a medal-winning performance; it showed that India now had more than one athlete capable of winning medals in para sprinting, a genuine highlight for the country's para-athletics programme.

The shot put field then provided another occasion for the Indian flag to fly high. Subedar Soman Rana won the men's F57 event with a throw of 13.40m, while Shubham Juyal completed another Indian one-two with 13.28m.

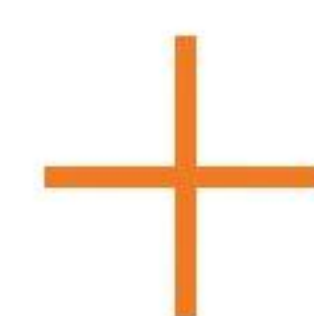
The campaign had, however, begun with success outside athletics. Jhandu Kumar won bronze in the men's heavyweight para powerlifting event, opening India's medal account at the Games. His podium finish

provided an early indication that India's para contingent had arrived in Glasgow ready to compete across disciplines.

What stood out was the manner in which the athletes approached the competition.

They were not merely content with participation; they competed for medals and, in several events, challenged confidently for the top positions. They were no longer simply looking to make up the numbers, but capable of making their presence felt at the highest level.

The performances in Glasgow have given Indian para sport another important step forward: from producing occasional medal winners to building a group of athletes capable of competing, winning and making history on the Commonwealth stage.



Medallists in para athletics at the CWG

Jhandu Kumar — Men's heavyweight, Para powerlifting, Bronze

Sharmila Dhankar — Women's shot put F57, Gold

Shilpa K Shyla — Women's shot put F57, Bronze

Dilip Gavit — Men's 100m T47, Gold

Mohammed Basil — Men's 100m T47, Silver

Soman Rana — Men's shot put F57, Gold

Shubham Juyal — Men's shot put F57, Silver